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FB's teen-only network

Facebook's new iOS app, Lifestage, is their latest youth play to lure teens
<http://dgit.in/fblifestage>

mented Reality front, Coursera offers a course titled "Getting started with Augmented Reality" that is created by Institut Mines-Télécom, which is France's premier group of engineering and management graduate schools.

The push to create a better situation for VR and AR learning in academic institutions has to come from the VR and AR content industry. "Unfortunately, there aren't any specific courses offered by any of the universities so far in Indian-sub continent which specifically cater to career building in

in VR and AR right now. There are mainly two categories of tools that are required for non-capture type VR content. Modelling tools let you create the world and things in it, and then you move those to real time engines to create the entire VR experience. Here are some of the most popular real time engines in VR and AR development right now:

- **Unreal Engine:** In the game development industry, Unreal Engine needs no introduction. From a platform that lets you create experiences

you can download it right now to get started on your first VR project. Oh yes, this is also free.

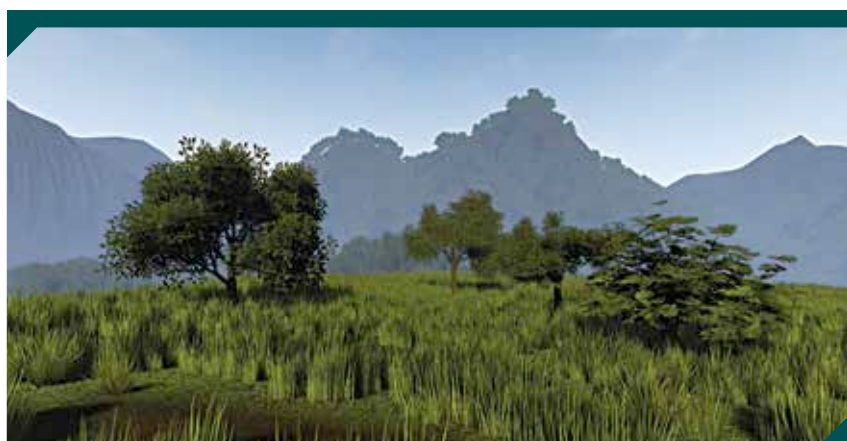
- **Cryengine:** One of the most visually rich development platforms out there, games developed on Cryengine are probably the most used to benchmark the true capabilities of a computer. The free-to-use trend from the other two big players in this field has recently influenced the pricing model of this engine as well. It used to be paid, but now developers around the world can pay what they want to get access to this engine, even nothing.

Some of the more popular modelling tools are:

- **Blender:** The open source software world has given us some really good options, and Blender is no different. This free modelling and animation software has grown on to rival industry leading tools like Maya and Softimage. The number of tools and features available on Blender are powerful enough to be your only tool for creating the world for your entire game. The inbuilt game engine is also useful, but not as VR capable as some of the RTEs mentioned earlier. And as with most good open source software, there is a very vibrant community with a lot of helpful content out there.
- **Sculptris:** This one is for the sake of doing one job really well. While this one has limited capability, creating models in this software feels exactly like sculpting clay and offers a lot of detail. Give this a shot if you are up for trying something different.
- **Other Alternatives:** Some of the other good options are Sketchup Make, Wings 3D, Equinox 3d, Daz studio, 3D crafter

Capture type content refers to VR video, which essentially has the entry barrier of hardware. But if you do manage to get a good setup in place, some of the software tools that you can use to work on VR capture content are:

- Adobe After Effects
- Final Cut Pro
- Kolor



Unreal Engine has been used to create some of the most beautiful virtual experiences out there

VR/AR industry.", says Mr. Abhishek, "But as we speak, ecosystem is getting better every day and the universities are trying to establish partnerships with young startups working in VR/AR space to build a curriculum specific to advance visualization. We are also specifically in conversation with some of the Tier-I institutes in India/Singapore region for creating some VR specific learning modules".

The Armory

Before you go for a full fledged course, or even if you have started learning more about the basics, you should be aware that there are a great number of tools out there for both sides of the game - technical as well as artistic. And that is one area where there is no dearth of resources. In fact, self learning on these tools using online resources is actually the best way to gain expertise

varying from retro-looking 2D platformers to full scale AAA realistic games, it is no surprise that they dived into VR when the time was ripe. They have an active marketplace from where you can obtain the resources to be used in your project, along with a very active community that creates a lot of tutorials and demonstrations. And if you don't know this already, Unreal Engine is free to use.

- **Unity 3D:** From a small development engine, in the past few years Unity has rapidly grown to become a considerable competitor to Unreal Engine. And with the upcoming number of full scale VR devices, there is a huge opportunity for Unity to fight toe to toe with UE for the development share, since they are actively going after the community. It is quite easy to use and